

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1565

By Warner

A RESOLUTION to honor James H. Bingham on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of public service; and

WHEREAS, James H. Bingham is one such estimable person who has served for three terms as Mayor of Lewisburg, from which position he will take his much-deserved retirement this year; and

WHEREAS, throughout his exemplary tenure as mayor, Mr. Bingham has distinguished himself as a public-spirited citizen of the highest order and as an exceptional asset to his community; and

WHEREAS, born on October 21, 1942, in Hardin County, Mr. Bingham is the son of James Howard and Dorothy Newman Bingham and the brother of William and Catherine; and

WHEREAS, in 1944, the Bingham family moved to Warren, Michigan, where Mr. Bingham's father worked for the Packard Company, and his younger brother, Ronald, was born; James Bingham attended elementary and junior high school there and was an active member of the Boy Scouts; and

WHEREAS, the family moved to Nashville in 1958, when Mr. Bingham's father secured a job with the United States Postal Service, and James Bingham attended Cohn, Central, and David Lipscomb high schools; he graduated from David Lipscomb High School in 1960 and earned a bachelor's degree in engineering from Vanderbilt University in 1964; and

WHEREAS, following his undergraduate studies, Mr. Bingham served the Tennessee Department of Transportation (TDOT) as a highway design engineer and was later promoted to

assistant regional design engineer; he further served TDOT as an assistant state rural roads engineer and as chief of local programs; and

WHEREAS, in 1968, he married, Carolyn Newlon, an educator with Metro Nashville school system; and

WHEREAS, together, James and Carolyn Bingham made their home in the Madison community, and their first daughter, Jamie Carol, was born in 1972; Elizabeth Ann "Betsy" arrived in 1975, and their family became complete with the birth of their son, James Andrew "Drew" in 1980; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bingham left TDOT and relocated to Marshall County in 1978, where he established Bingham Engineering in Lewisburg; his firm provided professional engineering services and land surveying; and

WHEREAS, throughout the years, James Bingham has been actively involved in his community, attending Church Street Church of Christ, where he has served as a co-teacher in a Sunday School class, delivered meals through the Saturday Meals program, and participated in mission trips to Montana, Mexico, and Ghana; he also served as a deacon and elder; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bingham is a highly respected member of his community, having served in numerous capacities over the past forty-eight years, including as President of the Lewisburg Lions Club; President of the Marshall County Community Theatre; Chairman of the Tennessee State Service Council of the American Red Cross; Chairman of the Tennessee Children's Home Board of Directors; Tennessee State Representative of the Southeast U.S./Japan Association; and as a member of the Marshall County Commission, which he served for two terms; and

WHEREAS, in addition to sponsoring a local Little League team, Mr. Bingham contributed his engineering expertise to designing the Richard Cashion Little League Complex, and he continues to serve his community as a dedicated member of the Duck River Advisory Board; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bingham has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity throughout his professional and public service career, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his community; and

WHEREAS, his remarkable success as a public servant and civic leader is directly attributable to his reliance on the time-honored values of hard work and common sense and his uncommon ability to work well with people from all walks of life; and

WHEREAS, a strong advocate for the citizens of this State, Mr. Bingham is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor James H. Bingham for his honorable and astute service to the citizens of this State and extend to him our best wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.